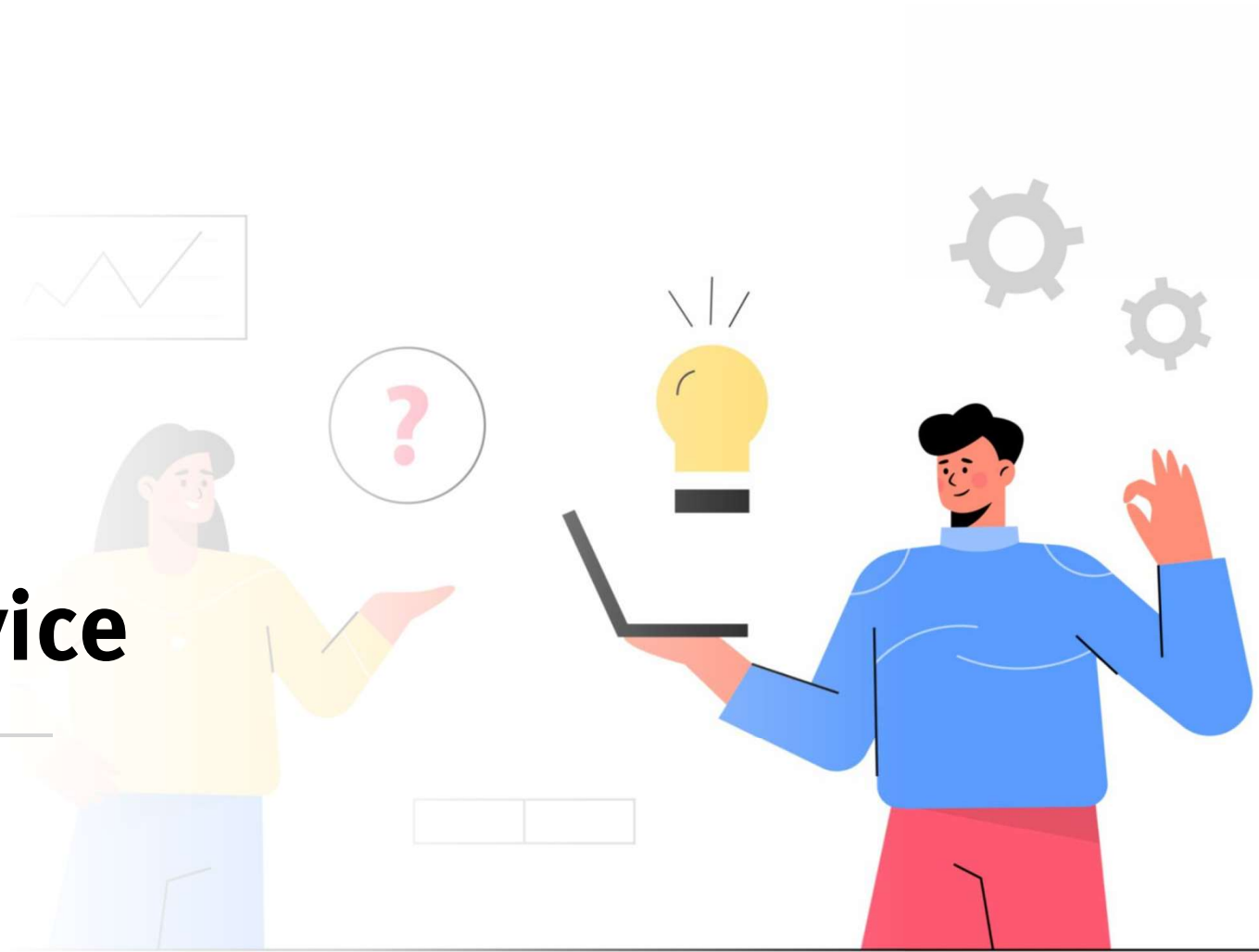




Here's my advice

Working with others



Agenda

- Reading: Want my advice?
- Vocabulary: Collocations with *get* and *take*
- Language: Asking for and giving advice tactfully
- Pronunciation: Pitch for sounding tactfully



Vocabulary

Scan the post again. Complete the definitions with the correct form of the collocations in bold.

1. If you _____, you try to help in a situation.
2. If you _____ someone, you manage to help them understand something.
3. If you _____ off your _____, you talk about something that is worrying or upsetting you.
4. If you _____ someone's _____ a problem, you help them forget about it for a while.
5. If you _____ something _____, you make a mistake with it.
6. If you say something to someone and they _____, they get upset and think that you are criticising them.
7. If you _____ you accept it and act on it.
8. If someone _____, they understand what you are saying to them.

1 get involved	5 get, wrong
2 get through to	6 take it personally
3 get something, chest	7 take advice
4 take, mind off	8 gets the message



Want my advice?

Emily Atkins | Friday 12 July | 11.22 GMT

Advice is a funny thing, isn't it? Many of us love to **get involved** and give advice to someone with a problem. It's so satisfying to play the part of the wise friend! But actually, when people want to talk about their problems, they very rarely want advice. All they want is to **get something off their chest**. They want someone to listen to them in a sympathetic way, and help them **take their mind off** their problems for a while. They're very unlikely to **take advice** from anyone, because they actually need to work out the solutions for themselves.

On the other hand, we've all been in situations where someone desperately needs some honest advice. Maybe they're putting all their efforts into trying to make it as an actor, and they can't understand why they aren't a famous film star yet. The truth is, they can't act, but not even their closest friends are able to **get through to** them. Whatever their friends say, they don't seem to **get the message**.

Also, a lot of us find it hard to give truly honest advice, even if our friends desperately need it. We don't want to **get it wrong** and suggest something that ruins their life. And we don't want them to **take it personally** and be upset.

But it's important to help people when they need it. So, if you want my advice: stick to sympathy when someone comes to you with a problem, and give honest suggestions when you can.

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Language



Complete the expressions from the conversations by adding one word in each gap.
Listen again and check.

Conversation 1

1. Ryan, I hope you don't take this the _____ way, but I'm not sure it's a good idea to stop studying.
2. Look, I'm telling you this as a _____, Ryan.
3. Well, have you _____ about getting some lessons?
4. To be _____, it might be useful to focus a bit more on your technique.
5. So, what _____ you do?
6. But if I _____ you, I definitely wouldn't leave university!

Conversation 2

7. Don't take this _____, but you do go out a lot, don't you?
8. Yes, but perhaps you _____ to see friends just at the weekends?
9. What do you _____ ?
10. Well, it _____ be an idea to buy fewer clothes.
11. I don't want you to get the _____ _____, but I just think generally you could be a bit more careful with money.
12. My _____ would be to set a budget each month.

1 wrong	2 friend	3 thought
4 honest	5 would	6 were
7 personally	8 ought	9 think
10 might	11 idea	12 advice



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Language

Asking for advice

What do you think I should do?
What would you do?
What do you think?
Can you give me some advice about ... ?
What would you recommend/suggest?

Giving advice tactfully

When we are giving sensitive advice (which could be embarrassing for the person who receives it), we use phrases to prepare the listener. These help to soften the message. Several of these phrases focus on how the listener should view the advice.

I hope you don't take this the wrong way, but you can sometimes come across as slightly rude.

I don't want you to get the wrong idea, but I'm not sure I want to be in the band anymore.

Don't take it personally, but the clothes you wear to work aren't always suitable for the office.

Preparing the listener for sensitive advice

I hope you don't take this the wrong way, but ...
I don't want you to get the wrong idea, but ...
Don't take it personally, but ...
I'm telling you this as a friend.
To be honest, ...

When giving advice tactfully, we often use modal verbs like *could* and *might* to soften the message.

It might be a good idea to spend a bit more time preparing before you go for interviews.

You could try paying a bit more attention in meetings.

We also use *perhaps* and *maybe* to make it clear that our advice is only a suggestion, not an order.

Maybe you should go to bed earlier.

Perhaps you should talk to your manager.

Giving advice tactfully

My advice would be to + infinitive without *to*

If you want my advice, you should ...

You should definitely ...

Perhaps you should/ought to ...

It's probably/It might be a good idea to + infinitive without *to*

Have you thought about/considered + *-ing* form

If I were you, I'd ...



Pronunciation



Do the speakers start with a high pitch or a low pitch? Do they get higher or lower?

1. Perhaps you should try to cut back on your spending a bit.
2. It might be a good idea to get there on time in future.
3. Have you thought about maybe going to bed a bit earlier?
4. My advice would be to maybe go to a more experienced hairdresser.

The speakers start with a high pitch and get higher.



Lektor

That's all, folks!

